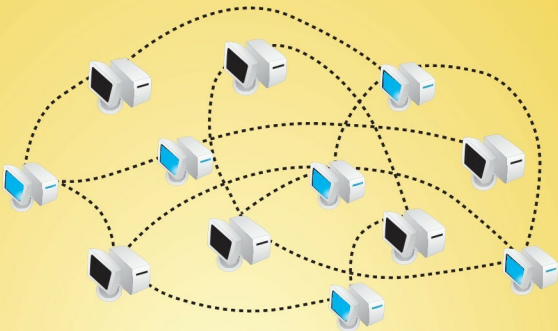




Learning About Nmap

Nmap, the network mapping tool, is the starting point when analysing any network. It is an exciting tool—compact and power-packed. This article looks at the range of functions and options it supports.

The Nmap man page describes it as a security/network exploration tool and port-scanner. Nmap (Network Mapper) is a versatile open source tool, which systems administrators can't do without. Some of its interesting features include:

- It's fast!

- Uses raw IP packets in various innovative ways for scanning.
- Can detect operating system versions (and if it's unable to detect, it requests the user to send the scan signature to the developer, for incorporation in future versions of Nmap).
- Provides various interesting options to scan the network.